

3 Manoj Kumar Director, 1937-

He discovered the desi dil beating in the diaspora in *Purab aur Paschim*, 1970, and the common man's concerns in *Roti Kapda aur Makaan*, 1974. By the mid-70s, Manoj Kumar's career was in creative decline but his influence remains, whether it is Rani Mukherji's bhajan in *Kuch Kuch Hota Hai* or Akshay Kumar's role in *Namaste London*.

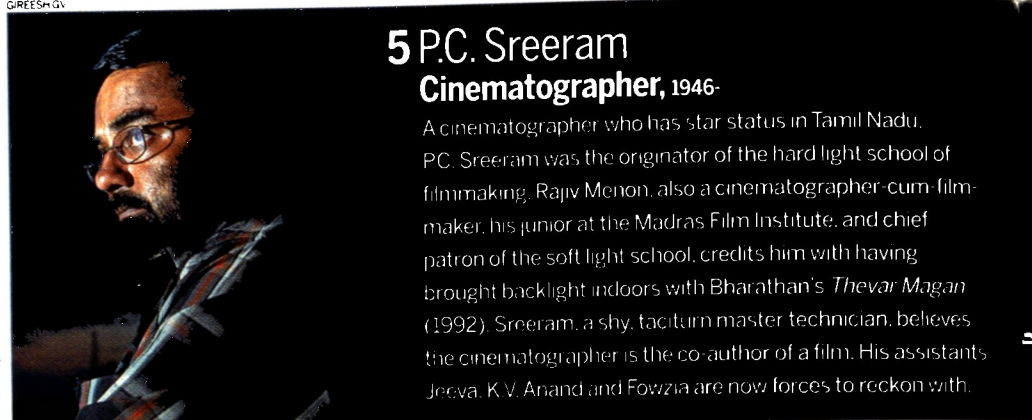


4 Subrata Mitra Cinematographer, 1930-2001

Beginning his career as a still photographer, he developed bounce lighting much before the world discovered it, giving films such as *Pathar Panchali* and *The Householder* their humanism. A perfectionist is how Sandip Ray describes his father Satyajit's closest associate, who is taught in cinema schools today with something close to awe.



GIREESH GIL



5 P.C. Sreeram Cinematographer, 1946-

A cinematographer who has star status in Tamil Nadu, P.C. Sreeram was the originator of the hard light school of filmmaking. Rajiv Menon, also a cinematographer-cum-filmmaker, his junior at the Madras Film Institute, and chief patron of the soft light school, credits him with having brought backlight indoors with Bharathan's *Thevar Magan* (1992). Sreeram, a shy, taciturn master technician, believes the cinematographer is the co-author of a film. His assistants Jeeva, K.V. Anand and Fowzia are now forces to reckon with.



6 Vijay Anand Director, 1934-2004

As Nasreen Munni Kabir writes, "Much is written about the master filmmakers of the 1950s, but somehow the 1960s directors have mostly slipped through the net. When this decade is reappraised, Vijay Anand's work will stand out amongst the most exciting. From his first film, *Nau Do Gyarah* in 1957 to *Johnny Mera Naam* in 1970, he was clear that screenplay, direction, getting the best out of his performers and film editing must all emanate from the same mindset for a film to work. Vijay Anand mastered all these elements in his original and gifted approach to cinema." Even today, his songs in *Tere Ghar ke Saamne*, *Teesri Manzil* and *Guide* influence filmmakers with their framing techniques.

7 Kader Khan Actor and Dialogue Writer, 1937-

Movie-goers will remember him for his often crude comedy in later films—after all, he acted in over 300 movies—but his way with words was an important part of Manmohan Desai films such as *Amar Akbar Anthony*



(1977) and *Naseeb* (1981). Desai called it "roadside dialogue" and told film scholar Connie Haham that Khan was a master of the "colloquial idiom". He wrote *Khoon Pasina* and *Lawaaris* for the other giant of the 1970s as well, Prakash Mehra.